

CONTACT

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Data Mining
Data Science
Natural Language Processing
Recommender System

LANGUAGES

English

Bilingual
High proficiency in reading and writing

Chinese

Mandarin
Native Fluency

Chinese

Cantonese
Native Fluency

XURONG (JASON) LIANG

梁旭荣

Ph.D. Student, Research Assistant & Teaching Assistant
Computer Science

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Computer Science
University of Queensland, Australia

2023 — Jan 2027

Ph.D. project *Toward Memory-Efficient Recommender Systems*
Advised by Prof. Hongzhi Yin and Assoc. Prof. Rocky Tong Chen.

Bachelor of Computer Science (Honors)
University of Queensland, Australia

2022

Honors project *PEP++: Improved Pruning-Based Embedding Dimension Optimization for Recommender Systems*
Advised by Assoc. Prof. Rocky Tong Chen.
Awarded an **Honors Class I Degree (cumulative GPA 7.000/7.000)**.

Bachelor of Computer Science
University of Queensland, Australia

2019 — 2021

Graduated with cumulative **GPA 6.792/7.000**. Major in **Data Science**.

High School Diploma
Indooroopilly State High School, Australia

2016 — 2018

Graduated with **OP4** (Highest: 1, Lowest: 25).

PUBLICATIONS

In-context Learning for Addressing User Cold-start in Sequential Movie Recommenders
paper

RecSys '25

Xurong Liang, Vu Nguyen, Vuong Le, Paul Albert, Julien Monteil

Lightweight Embeddings with Graph Rewiring for Collaborative Filtering
Paper

TOIS '25

Xurong Liang, Tong Chen, Wei Yuan, and Hongzhi Yin

Lightweight Embeddings for Graph Collaborative Filtering
Paper, Code

SIGIR '24

Xurong Liang, Tong Chen, Lizhen Cui, Yang Wang, Meng Wang, and Hongzhi Yin

Hate Speech Detection with Generalizable Topic-aware Fairness
[Paper](#), [Code](#)

KDD '24

Tong Chen, Danny Wang, **Xurong Liang**, Marten Risius, Gianluca Demartini and Hongzhi Yin

Learning Compact Compositional Embeddings via Regularized Pruning for Recommendation
[Paper](#), [Code](#)

ICDM '23

Xurong Liang, Tong Chen, Quoc Viet Hung Nguyen, Jianxin Li, and Hongzhi Yin

ACHIEVEMENTS

Dean's Commendation for Academic Excellence — Bachelor of Computer Science (Hons)
University of Queensland, Australia

2022

Awarded to students who obtained a grade point average of 6.60 or higher in single semester.

Dean's Commendation for Academic Excellence — Bachelor of Computer Science
University of Queensland, Australia

2019 — Jul 2021

Awarded to students who obtained a grade point average of 6.60 or higher in single semester.

Cloud Computing INFS3208 Best Project Runner-up Award
University of Queensland, Australia

2021

Awarded for outstanding performance in INFS3208 Cloud Computing individual project competition 2021.

Prentice Scholar 2020
University of Queensland, Australia

2020

Prentice Scholars are students whose academic performance sits within the top five percent of the undergraduate Computer Science and Information Technology cohort at The University of Queensland.

Subject Prize Award – Information Processing and Technology
Indooroopilly State High School, Australia

2017

Ranked 1st in the Information Processing and Technology course cohort.

SCHOLARSHIPS

Australian Government Research Training Program (RTP) Scholarship

2023 — 2026

Google Research Travel Scholarship

2024

UQ International Onshore Merit Scholarship

2022

ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

Applied Scientist Internship

Oct 2024 — May 2025

Amazon, Australia

Spearheaded research leveraging Large Language Models (LLMs) and in-context learning to solve the **user cold-start problem** within a commercial video streaming platform. The framework proposed during this internship was successfully published at **RecSys '25**. Conducted this research under the guidance of Dr. Julien Monteil, Dr. Vu Nguyen, Dr. Vuong Le and Dr. Paul Albert.

Head Tutor & Teaching Assistant

Feb 2022 — Jul 2026

University of Queensland, Australia

Served as the Head Tutor for both **INFS7901 – Database Principles** and **INFS3208/INFS7208 - Cloud Computing**. Directed weekly practical and tutorial sessions, managed course administration, and coordinated the comprehensive marking of assignments and examination papers.

Casual Research Assistant

Sep 2021 — Sep 2024

University of Queensland, Australia

Conducted research experiments, data preprocessing, baseline testing, and algorithm implementation in the fields of **Explainable Recommender Systems** and **Hate Speech Detection**. A work contributed to a novel hate speech detection framework successfully published at **KDD '24**.

Winter Research Scholar

Jun 2021 — Jul 2021

University of Queensland, Australia

Dynamic Topic Modelling on Social Media — Utilizing **Natural Language Processing (NLP)** techniques to model and analyze the change of trending topics on social media in relation to COVID-19 throughout the first 100-day period since the virus emerged. Project conducted under the supervision of Prof. Zi (Helen) Huang and Assoc. Prof. Rocky Tong Chen. Project result visualization available at <https://topicvis.nifu.me/>.

Voluntary Teaching Assistant

Dec 2019 — Jan 2020

Dalu Primary School (大芦小学), Yulin, Guangxi 537000, China

Teaching English and Information Technology courses to elementary school students. In charge of homework materials organization and marking.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Self-employed Courier Delivery Service

Dec 2020 — Feb 2021

Brisbane, QLD 4000, Australia

Contracting last-mile delivery orders with courier providers such as 1stEx® and CouriersPlease® in particular regions around the Greater Brisbane Region.

Expo Helper

Jul 2017

AAS Education & Student Services, Spring Hill, QLD 4000, Australia

Assisting prospective students in answering any inquiries regarding further studies abroad. Assisting in student recruitment and encouraging prospective genuine students to apply to the institute on-site.

Voluntary International Student Ambassador
Indooroopilly State High School, Australia

Jan 2017

Assisting new students at International Student Orientation and providing school tours for visiting delegates.